

ID.4 Where to File Directory

Idaho publishes no list of who enforces what — here is the method, the offices that exist regardless, and two cities as worked examples.

Before you use this document

This is a process reference, not legal advice. Idaho's Building Code Act does not put a private house under a building permit by itself — it authorizes each city and county to adopt and enforce a code, and where none has, there is no residential building permit, plan review, inspection or certificate of occupancy. The state Division of Occupational and Professional Licenses (DOPL) issues no building permit for a house. What does not depend on any of that: the electrical, plumbing and HVAC permits, which are statewide; the health-district septic permit; and the IDWR well drilling permit. The unit is the **jurisdiction** — a city inside a county routinely differs from the county around it. Confirm every item with the office that will actually handle your parcel before you rely on it. Every web address here was checked in September 2026. Programs move in both directions — a county can adopt a building code at any time, and trade programs transfer to and from DOPL — so re-check before you file, not just before you buy.

HOW TO TELL AN ENFORCING JURISDICTION FROM ONE THAT IS NOT

No state agency publishes the answer, and the statute is why: any local government "may elect to implement a building code enforcement program by passing an ordinance" (§ 39-4116(1)), so a list would be stale the day it printed. What the statute does give you is a document that **must** exist wherever a building permit is required.

The five-minute method

	Step
1	City first, then county. Inside city limits the city's ordinance governs; outside, the county's. Search the city or county website for "building permit" and "building department."
2	Look for the permit-process document. "A local government that requires building permits shall make available a document that describes in detail the requirements of its building permit process ... on its website and in physical form upon request" (§ 39-4117(1)). Found it: enforcing. Not found: ask for it by that section number.
3	No building department? Get it in writing. A dated email from the clerk or planning office stating that no building-code ordinance has been adopted for the parcel's location. File it with the deed.
4	Now the trade side, separately. Open DOPL's electrical permits page and follow "Purchase your permit on-line HERE Based on location" — the map tells you whether DOPL or a local program issues each trade permit at your address. The three answers can differ from each other.
5	Write all four answers on the cover — building permit from, and electrical, plumbing and HVAC permits from — with the date you confirmed them.

Trade programs move. A city or county starting its own electrical or plumbing enforcement "shall provide the division ... notice of such decision in writing at least thirty (30) days prior to implementation" (§ 54-1001B(4); § 54-2601(7)); one that terminates a program hands it back, and DOPL "shall provide ... enforcement services in the jurisdiction for a minimum of one (1) year" (§ 54-1001B(5); § 54-2601(8)). DOPL's HVAC board news records one going the other way: "Canyon County HVAC Program Coming to DOPL September 1, 2023." The map is current; a two-year-old forum answer is not.

DOPL — ONE OFFICE, INSPECTORS BY CITY

The Division of Occupational and Professional Licenses runs the electrical, plumbing and HVAC programs and contractor registration from Boise — its forms say "email or mail all license applications, permit applications, fees, or forms to the Boise office" — and puts inspectors in the field by city and ZIP code. There are no regional permit counters. Three things to know how to find:

Finding your way around DOPL

What you need	Where it is
The permit	"As of January 1, 2023, all permits will need to be purchased Online at DBS.IDAHO.GOV " — the forms still print, but the transaction is online. Register a free account, then buy the homeowner electrical, plumbing or HVAC permit. Each trade page at dopl.idaho.gov links the purchase and the location map
The inspector	The Inspector List with Schedules — linked from every trade's permit page — lists each city and ZIP with its electrical, HVAC and plumbing inspector and their inspection days. The copy read for this kit was created 5 August 2026; the file is re-issued and its name changes. There is no building column, because DOPL inspects no houses
The inspection request	eTRAKiT, linked from each permit page ("To schedule your inspection online please click HERE "): find the permit, Request Inspection, choose the type and date. Next-day requests until 7 p.m. Mountain. Or the inspection line with the codes in ID.3
The license check	DOPL's public search — contractor registrations, electrical licenses, plumbing and HVAC certificates, discipline — is at edopl.idaho.gov , Online Services → Public Search

THE SEVEN HEALTH DISTRICTS, BY COUNTY

Septic permits do not come from DEQ. "Idaho's seven public health districts administer these rules under a memorandum of understanding (MOU) with DEQ. The public health districts conduct site evaluations, issue septic system permits, inspect installations" (DEQ septic page). The districts are fixed by statute, county by county (§ 39-408):

Idaho Code § 39-408 — "There is hereby established ... seven (7) public health districts"

No.	District	Counties	Website
1	Panhandle Health District	Boundary, Bonner, Kootenai, Benewah, Shoshone	panhandlehealthdistrict.org
2	Public Health – Idaho North Central District	Latah, Clearwater, Nez Perce, Lewis, Idaho	idahopublichealth.com
3	Southwest District Health	Adams, Washington, Payette, Gem, Canyon, Owyhee	swdh.org
4	Central District Health	Valley, Boise, Ada, Elmore	cdh.idaho.gov
5	South Central Public Health District	Camas, Blaine, Gooding, Lincoln, Jerome, Minidoka, Twin Falls, Cassia	phd5.idaho.gov
6	Southeastern Idaho Public Health	Power, Oneida, Bannock, Franklin, Caribou, Bear Lake, Bingham, Butte	siphidaho.org
7	Eastern Idaho Public Health	Lemhi, Custer, Clark, Jefferson, Bonneville, Teton, Madison, Fremont	eiph.idaho.gov

Ask your district for its septic-permit application checklist and its fee schedule: the state rule sets minimum fees and each district "may adopt different fees ... [and] must have their fee schedules published online" (IDAPA 58.01.14.110), and the well rules note that "additional siting and separation distance requirements are set forth by the governing district health department" (IDAPA 37.03.09.025.01.d). The statewide separations in ID.2 are floors.

TWO CITIES THAT RUN THEIR OWN TRADE PROGRAMS

Both verified from the city's own pages in September 2026. They are printed as worked examples of what a local program looks like, not as a list — DOPL's map is the list.

Two local programs, from the cities' own pages

City	What its page says	Where
Boise	Planning and Development Services, Building Division. Its fee page carries four separate schedules — Building Code, Plumbing Code, Mechanical Code and Fuel Gas Code, and Electrical Code (FY27) — so inside Boise all three trade permits are the city's, on the city's fees, with the city's inspectors. The Idaho electrical and plumbing codes remain the standard by statute. The city also publishes permit-processing timeframes by quarter	cityofboise.org → Planning and Development Services → Building

Two local programs, from the cities' own pages

City	What its page says	Where
Coeur d'Alene	Building Services "has adopted the 2018 International Codes" and enforces "all applicable building, mechanical, accessibility, plumbing and housing codes." Plumbing: "Local plumbing codes will remain under the 2017 Idaho State Plumbing code with current City Amendments" — a city program with its own amendments, as § 54-2601 allows after a hearing. Ask the counter which trade permits it issues itself and which go to DOPL	cdaid.org/building

THE SEQUENCE, WHATEVER YOUR STATUS

"No building permit" is not "no paperwork." The risk is doing these in the wrong order, because two of them constrain where the house can physically sit.

Eight steps, in order

	Step	Which office, and why the order
1	Confirm both statuses	Building-code status from the city or county; trade-permit authority from DOPL's map. Before relying on any of the rest
2	Septic site evaluation	The health district. The 20% slope limit, the two-drainfield rule and the 100-ft well separation decide where the house and well can go — before the footprint is fixed
3	Zoning and address	Local land-use approval under the Local Land Use Planning Act and a 911 address are county and city matters the building code never touched; a no-code county still has zoning setbacks. Ask the planning office
4	Well drilling permit	IDWR, \$75, before the rig arrives. Only a licensed driller may drill; find one in IDWR's licensed-driller search
5	Building permit	If, and only if, the jurisdiction enforces a code. Its process document lists what to submit; the 10-business-day completeness clock starts at receipt
6	Three trade permits	DOPL online, or the city or county program. Electrical before any wiring; plumbing before groundwork; HVAC with the Manual J/S/D calculations
7	Utility	Ask what the power supplier needs before it will set a meter. By statute that includes a passed DOPL (or local) electrical inspection; decide the temporary-power route in ID.3 first
8	Utility locate	Call 811 before any excavation. DOPL's permit page warns that the excavation portion of a permit "may be suspended" for a violation of Title 55, Chapter 22

STATE-LEVEL ADDRESSES

All confirmed to resolve in September 2026. **We print no phone numbers anywhere in this kit** — they go stale faster than anything else on a printed page, and every office below can be reached from its own site.

Verified September 2026

What you need	Where
Trade permits, by location	dopl.idaho.gov/e/e-permits/ — "Purchase your permit on-line HERE Based on location" opens the map. Plumbing and HVAC: /plb/plb-permits/ and /hvac/hvac-permits/
Buy the permit, request inspections	dbs.idaho.gov — the online permitting system named on every DOPL form; eTRAKiT is linked from each permit page
Inspector by city	"Inspector List with Schedules" — linked from dopl.idaho.gov/plb/plb-permits/ and the other trade pages
Check a registration or license	edopl.idaho.gov/OnlineServices/?link=PubSearch
Building Code Board; rulemaking status	dopl.idaho.gov/bld/bld-statutes-and-rules/
Septic — the rules, and your district	deq.idaho.gov/water-quality/wastewater/septic-and-septage/ ("Find Your Public Health District"); district sites above
Wells — permit, drillers, well logs	idwr.idaho.gov/wells/ and idwr.idaho.gov/wells/well-construction/ (licensed-driller search, well-log search)
The statutes	legislature.idaho.gov/statutesrules/idstat/ — Title 39, Chapter 41 (building); Title 54, Chapters 10, 26, 50, 52; Title 42 (wells)
The rules	adminrules.idaho.gov/rules/current/24/243930.pdf (building), 243910.pdf (electrical), 243920.pdf (plumbing), 243970.pdf (HVAC); /58/580103.pdf (septic); /37/370309.pdf (wells)

One address people will hand you that is dead: dbs.idaho.gov's old "building program" page, from before the Division of Building Safety was folded into DOPL, now redirects to DOPL's home page. The legacy statement that DBS enforced the code in unincorporated areas is gone with it; DOPL's Plan Review Application is the current word.

YOUR DIRECTORY — FILL THIS IN BEFORE YOU NEED IT

Every office that touches this build, confirmed and dated

	Item	Date	Notes
☐	Building-code status of my CITY and my COUNTY, where I found the § 39-4117(1) document or the written statement that there is none, and the building permit office (if any) with the code edition it reviews to: City _____ County _____ Date _____ Office _____ Edition _____		
☐	Electrical, plumbing and HVAC permits from (DOPL or local), per the map; my DOPL inspectors from the Inspector List, and their days: Elec. _____ Plb. _____ HVAC _____ Date _____ Inspectors / days _____		
☐	Public health district No. ____ and the office I file the septic application with: Office _____		
☐	Zoning / planning office and its setbacks; 911 addressing office; floodplain administrator and whether the parcel is in a mapped hazard area: Zoning _____ Setbacks _____ 911 _____ Flood: in / out _____		
☐	Driveway approach or encroachment permit — which road authority owns the road I touch — and the date I called 811 before excavating: Authority _____ 811 called _____		
☐	Electric utility or co-op, and what it needs before setting a meter: Utility _____ Requires _____		

Everything cited here is free to read. Statutes are at legislature.idaho.gov → Idaho Statutes, one section per page (.../idstat/Title54/T54CH10/SECT54-1016/), each ending with a History line naming every session law that amended it. Rules are at adminrules.idaho.gov, one PDF per IDAPA chapter (.../rules/current/24/243910.pdf), every paragraph carrying its own effective date. **One warning:** DOPL is not your building department — its own form says so. Read September 2026.